Mike Czarnecki

Senior Director, Cybersecurity & AI Risk Oversight | Cybersecurity & Technology Risk Leadership

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity and technology risk executive with 20+ years of experience protecting financial institutions, federal agencies, and global enterprises through scalable, compliant, and future-ready programs. Known for building resilient security operations, integrating AI and automation responsibly, and translating complex risks into board-level outcomes. Proven success driving alignment across cybersecurity, data protection, and risk management to reduce exposure, enable innovation, and maintain regulatory trust under frameworks including NIST CSF 2.0, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, OCC, NYDFS 500, SOX, and GDPR. Experienced in embedding data protection, privacy, model-risk controls, and Zero Trust principles into enterprise AI and cloud ecosystems while monitoring emerging global standards such as DORA and MAS TRM.

IMPACT HIGHLIGHTS

- Delivered 40% reduction in incident response dwell time and 99.9% system uptime through cloud-native modernization and control validation initiatives.
- Launched the AI Trust Framework and Project Sentinel, embedding AI risk, resilience, and threat-validation governance across multi-cloud environments.
- Mentored and advanced 12 emerging leaders, 4 promoted into management roles, while achieving 95% team retention across distributed engineering functions.

EXPERIENCE

American Express – **Senior Director, Cybersecurity & AI Risk Oversight**

New York, NY | Feb 2025 – Present

- Directed enterprise security and AI risk oversight across 200+ global platforms, protecting data, payments, and customer analytics.
- Launched the AI Trust Framework: integrated NIST AI RMF principles into the AI governance lifecycle, ensuring fairness, transparency, and security.
- Led Operation Helix, a hybrid-cloud segmentation and encryption modernization improving infrastructure resilience 38% and audit readiness enterprise-wide.
- Partnered with Engineering, Legal, and Data Science to embed AI observability controls, IAM enhancements, and privacy safeguards into production pipelines.
- Instituted AI model review checkpoints to validate compliance, enabling $20 M+ in new digital product launches under secure model governance.
- Avoided $5 M+ in potential regulatory exposure through proactive control testing and AI model assurance.

- Partnered with Legal and Corporate Communications during critical incidents to brief executives and regulators, ensuring accurate risk framing and consistent messaging.
- Regularly briefed Board Risk Committee and regulators on cybersecurity posture, AI governance progress, and control effectiveness metrics.
- Established a formal Cyber Talent Mentorship Program, developing future leaders and improving retention 95% across risk and engineering teams.
- Built board-level dashboards tracking control coverage, incident SLAs, and AI risk posture for regulatory and executive reporting.

Capital One – **Director, Security Engineering & Operations**

New York, NY | Nov 2020 – Nov 2024

- Directed enterprise cyber assessments, detection engineering, and threat validation programs spanning 70+ applications across AWS and Azure.
- Led Project Sentinel, unifying detection and automation capabilities via Kubernetes, Kafka, and SOAR to improve threat visibility and reduce MTTR 45%.
- Built Fusion Ops, a threat-fusion initiative aligning SOC, IT, and intel functions, cutting dwell time 37% and expanding proactive coverage 65%.
- Delivered $1.8 M annual operational savings through automation and optimized incident routing.
- Advanced Zero Trust adoption by integrating IAM and device posture validation for privileged and remote users.
- Integrated risk-based testing and continuous validation (BAS) tied to MITRE ATT&CK and NIST CSF controls.
- Partnered with internal audit and regulators to close OCC and Fed findings 100% on-time with zero repeat issues.
- Mentored 15 engineers; 5 advanced to lead roles, reinforcing a high-performance culture grounded in accountability and technical depth.

U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs – **Senior Manager, Cybersecurity**

New York, NY | Oct 2019 – Oct 2020

- Directed national security modernization across healthcare and benefits systems serving 9 M+ veterans.
- Implemented risk-based penetration testing aligned to NIST SP 800-115 and HIPAA/FISMA requirements.
- Built incident simulation and analyst training programs improving detection efficiency 35% and insider-risk response speed 30%.
- Co-led fraud-detection AI pilot improving false-positive reduction by 30% while maintaining compliance integrity.

Norges Bank Investment Management – **Cybersecurity Lead**

New York, NY | May 2018 – Oct 2020

- Directed global architecture modernization for a $1 T asset management portfolio, aligning controls with ISO 27001 and SOC 2.
- Deployed AI-driven risk scoring and vendor monitoring reducing third-party exposure 30%.
- Introduced GDPR-compliant data-protection framework and evidence lifecycle automation for audit readiness.
- Collaborated with EU regulators to map model risk and data privacy controls to financial resiliency standards.
- Mentored security engineers on advanced analytics and risk quantification practices.

Prudential Financial – **Cyber Threat Analyst**

Roseland, NJ | Nov 2015 – May 2018

- Engineered enterprise threat detection and DLP programs integrating Splunk, Bro IDS, and Microsoft ATP.
- Developed risk dashboards aligned to NIST CSF categories and corporate KRIs.
- Automated threat response processes reducing mean time to remediate by 42%.
- Partnered with actuarial and data teams to embed privacy-by-design principles into analytics and ML models.
- Supported audit and compliance functions with SOC 2 and SOX testing artifacts.

Earlier Roles

Realogy – Cybersecurity Analyst | Bayer – Information Security Analyst | Novartis – Security Specialist

EDUCATION

M.S. Cybersecurity – University of Maryland Global Campus
B.S. Cybersecurity – University of Maryland Global Campus
A.A.S. Computer Science – County College of Morris
Harvard Business School Online – Digital Innovation & Strategy, Digital Transformation, AI Strategy, Platform Business Models

CORE LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

- AI Risk & Governance: Applied NIST AI RMF to govern model development, testing, and ethics across AI/ML initiatives.
- Security Architecture & Resilience: Designed segmentation, encryption, IAM, and endpoint security standards for multi-cloud enterprises.
- Risk & Regulatory Alignment: Led cyber and AI risk programs mapped to NIST CSF 2.0, ISO 27001, OCC, NYDFS 500, SOX, GDPR, and CIS Controls.
- Global Regulatory Readiness: Monitored emerging frameworks (DORA, MAS TRM) to align enterprise controls with international standards.
- Program Governance & Metrics: Delivered KPI/KRI dashboards covering control coverage, SLA adherence, and risk reduction trends.

- Incident Response & Continuity: Directed tabletop and recovery exercises achieving rapid failover and zero data loss.
- Cross-Functional Collaboration: Partnered with Legal, Data Science, and Engineering to align AI ethics and cyber controls.
- Vendor & Third-Party Risk: Implemented continuous risk monitoring and AI-assisted due diligence for suppliers.
- Talent Development & Culture: Built mentorship pipelines, rotational programs, and career pathways driving 95% retention.

CERTIFICATIONS

CISSP | CISM | CCSP | CRISC | CISA | CCSK | GCIH | AWS Solutions Architect (Pro) | GCP Cloud Architect | MIT AI for Cybersecurity (xPRO)

CULTURE & FIT

Hands-on leader who blends technical depth with strategic vision and cultural empathy. Thrives in mission-driven environments where cybersecurity, data protection, and innovation intersect, building teams that deliver trust, resilience, and measurable business impact. Committed to inclusive leadership and equitable team growth. Built succession and leadership-pipeline programs ensuring continuity of key cyber and AI risk roles. Known for developing high-trust cultures where engineers understand risk context and business leaders understand resilience.